Disaster Management

I] Textbook Questions:

☆ 1 Mark Objectives ☆

1. Identify the type of disaster.

Disaster	Type	Disaster	Type
Terrorism	Manmade – International disaster	Forest fire	Biological- Plant disaster
Soil Erosion	Geophysical- Geological disaster	Famine	Geophysical- Atmospheric disaster
Hepatitis	Biological- Animal disaster	Theft	Manmade disaster

☆ 2 Marks Questions ☆

1. Write notes.

a. Disaster management Authority

Ans:

1. Disaster Management Act, 2005 has been passed in our country. According to this Act, the National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA) has been established at the national level to ensure timely and effective response to disasters.
2. This authority works in coordination with authorities at different levels - from the national level to the village level.
3. These authorities keep continuous contact with various agencies like army, navy, telecommunication department, paramilitary organizations, and various voluntary organizations for their help in disaster management.
4. They systematically carry out rescue and rehabilitation work.

b. Nature of disaster management

Ans:

Taking into consideration the nature and scope of disaster, only three aspects of disaster are important for common citizens.

1. **Phase of emergency:**
   Various actions like search and rescue operations, medical assistance, first aid, restoring communication services, removing the people from affected area are expected in this phase. Gravity of disaster can be estimated in this phase only.

2. **Transitional Phase:**
   Rehabilitation work is started in this phase, after the subsidence of any type of disaster. It includes clearing of debris, restoring water supply, repairing roads, etc. so that it will help to bring normalcy in public life.

3. **Reconstruction Phase:**
   People reconstruct their buildings and facilities like roads and water supply are restored. Farming practices are restarted. However, it takes long time for reconstruction.

c. Mock drill OR Explain that why is it said like that? Mock drill is useful

Ans:

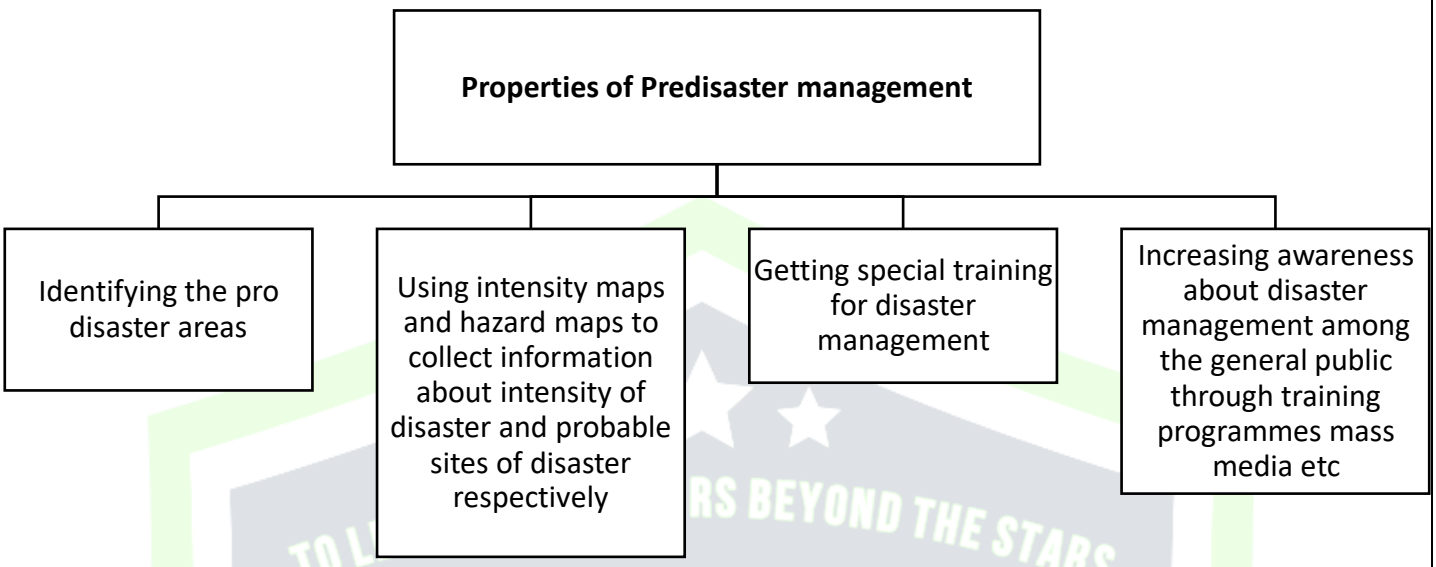
1. It is a practice to check the preparedness of facing the disaster as early as possible.
2. Virtual / Apparent situation of disaster is created to check the reaction time for any type of disaster.
3. Trained personnel observe their responsibilities to check execution of plan designed for disaster redressal.
4. Mock drill is arranged on disaster of fire in various schools by the fire fighters.
5. It includes the demonstrations like extinguishing the fire, rescuing the people trapped at higher floors of buildings, rescuing the persons whose clothing have caught the fire, etc.
6. This helps to check the efficacy of the system prepared for disaster redressal. Hence it is useful.

d. Disaster Management Act, 2005

Ans:

1. The Disaster Management Act, 2005, has been passed in India.
   According to this Act, a disaster management authority has been established at each level, i.e. national, state, district, taluka, and village.
2. These authorities plan and implement activities programmes for disaster management.
3. The National Disaster Response Force has been established as per the Disaster Management Act, 2005, with its headquarters in New Delhi.
4. 12 divisions of this force are working in the country with the help of the army.

2. Complete the following chart.



3. Which are the objectives of disaster management? **[2019-23-24-25-26]**

Ans:

Objectives of Disaster Management

1. Saving of human life during the calamity and release of the people.
2. Supply of essential commodities of the people to reduce the effect of disaster.
3. To restore the human life in the region by creating reconciliation in disaster.
4. Rehabilitate disaster victims.

☆ 3 Marks Questions ☆

1. Following are the pictures of some disasters. How will be your pre- and post-disaster management in case you face any of those disasters?



a. Gas Leakage from a Gas Cylinder [2026]

a. Pre-disaster Management

1. After using the gas stove, I will turn off the gas supply and keep the gas cylinder upright.
2. I will regularly check the gas tube and cylinder and get the tube replaced if it is damaged.
3. I will keep inflammable substances away from the gas cylinder and ensure proper ventilation.

b. Post-disaster Management

4. In case of leakage, I will close the gas valve and open all doors and windows without creating any spark.
5. If the leakage is severe, I will leave the place immediately and warn others not to switch electrical appliances on or off.
6. I will inform the gas supplier or emergency helpline and take necessary safety measures until help arrives.

b. Disaster Management – Fighting Between Children

1. Pre-disaster Management

1. If two students have a conflict, I will try to resolve it peacefully and help them understand each other.
2. If they start fighting, I will try to stop the fight and separate them safely.
3. If I cannot stop the fight, I will inform the teacher immediately so that the teacher can counsel them.

2. Post-disaster Management

1. If anyone is injured, I will provide first aid and arrange further help if needed.
2. I will find out the cause of the fight and make the students understand their mistakes and the importance of friendship.
3. I will counsel both students, redirect their attention towards a positive activity and encourage them to solve conflicts without fighting.

c. Disaster Management- Flooding Due to Heavy Rains [2025, 2026]

1. Pre-disaster Management

1. I will find out whether my home is located in a flood-prone area and identify a safe escape route.
2. I will keep emergency contact numbers ready and make sure all family members have them.
3. I will store non-perishable food, potable water for 2–3 days and a first-aid kit at home.
4. I will inform my neighbours about necessary precautions and encourage them to be prepared for flooding.

2. Post-disaster Management

1. After the flood, I will provide food, clean water and medical help to affected people whenever possible.
2. I will advise people to drink only boiled or safe water to prevent waterborne diseases.

d. Disaster Management -Cyclone

1. Pre-disaster Management

1. I will identify whether my area is located in a cyclone-prone zone.

2. I will advise my family members and neighbours to stay indoors when there is a possibility of a cyclone.
3. I will keep a sufficient stock of food, medicines and other essential items.
4. I will keep myself updated with the latest cyclone warnings and news.
5. I will keep an emergency kit ready with necessary supplies.

2. Post-disaster Management

1. After the cyclone, I will provide food, water and medical help to the affected people.

2. Some symbols are given below. Explain those symbols. Which disasters may occur if those symbols are ignored?



1. Symbol indicates **irritant substance**.
2. These substances cause irritation of the skin.
3. If consumed, they can burn the respiratory tract.
4. They can cause irritation if handled negligently, ignoring the symbol. They may cause toxicity if inhaled or swallowed.



1. This symbol signifies **hazardous or dangerous materials**, locations, or objects, including electric currents, poisons, and radioactive materials.
2. Ignoring it may lead to death.
3. Example: If one ignores this symbol and touches a high-voltage wire, he/she will get electrocuted and die.

4. Similarly, if one drinks a substance having this symbol, he/she may die as it may be poisonous or radioactive.



1. The symbol signifies that the substance is **hazardous to environment**.
2. Such a substance may harm or kill native species, including aquatic species, trees, and plants.
3. If a substance with this sign is thrown into a lake, it can harm or kill fish, aquatic plants, and other aquatic animals in the lake.



1. This symbol signifies a **cancer-causing agent (carcinogen) or substance with respiratory, reproductive, or organ toxicity** that causes damage over time (a chronic or long-term health hazard).
2. If one ignores this symbol and swallows such a substance, his/her internal organs may suffer damage.

3. It may cause allergy or asthmatic symptoms.



1. This symbol signifies **corrosive chemicals**.
2. When materials with this symbol come in contact with the human body, they can attack and chemically destroy exposed body tissues.
3. They can cause skin burns and eye damage. They can damage metals.



1. This symbol signifies **oxidizing substances**. Some substances do not burn themselves, but they provide oxygen for flammable substances to burn.
2. Such substances are labelled with the 'oxidizing' symbol.
3. They should be kept away from flammable substances and ignition sources. If this symbol is ignored and a substance with this symbol is kept near fire, it will enhance the fire and cause serious accident.
4. It will be very difficult to control such fire.



1. This symbol signifies **chemicals that ignite** very easily.
2. One should wear eye protection when handling these chemicals.
3. These chemicals should be kept away from flames and sparks, and also from oxidizing substances.
4. If this symbol is ignored, and such a substance is handled carelessly, it may cause fire.



1. This symbol signifies an **explosive substance**.
2. Explosive substances have enough stored energy.
3. They may explode on incorrect handling.
4. If one ignores this symbol and handles such substances carelessly, a big explosion may result causing loss of property and life.



1. This symbol signifies **gas under pressure.**
2. A cylinder carrying such a gas may explode, if heated.
3. If such a cylinder is heated unknowingly, it can cause cryogenic burns or Injury to people handling it as the cylinder may contain refrigerated gas.

3. Why is it essential to get the training of first aid? [2019]

Ans:

Importance of First Aid

1. We may face different types of major or minor disasters in our daily life, such as accidents, stampedes, electric shocks, burns and fires.
2. Disasters like fires due to electric short circuits and epidemics of diseases can occur at any time.
3. Victims of such disasters need immediate first aid before proper medical treatment is provided.

4. A person trained in first aid can provide immediate help and may save the life of a victim during a disaster.
5. The main objective of first aid is to prevent death, prevent the worsening of health conditions and help in recovery.
6. Therefore, it is essential for everyone to receive first-aid training to handle emergencies effectively.

☆ 5 Marks Questions ☆

1. Write down the reasons, effects and remedial measures taken for any two disasters experienced by you.

Ans:

I] Flooding in Mumbai

1. **Reasons:**
   - **i.** Heavy rainfall, cloudbursts and high tides cause flooding in Mumbai. Illegal constructions, destruction of mangroves and blockage of canals by plastic bags also contribute to flooding.
2. **Effects:** [2025]




   - **i.** Flooding causes damage to property and loss of human and animal life.
   - **ii.** Floodwater spreads diseases such as leptospirosis and cholera, creating serious health problems.
   - **iii.** People get stranded in buses, on roads and in unknown places. Electricity supply may also be cut off for several days.
3. **Remedial Measures:**
   - **i.** Immediate rescue operations are carried out.
   - **ii.** Food, water and shelter are provided to affected people, and disaster management units are established to handle the situation.

II] Sudden Fire

1. **Reasons:**
   - **i.** The restaurant did not have proper fire safety systems. Inflammable and hazardous substances were not stored properly.
   - **ii.** Employees were not trained to handle fire emergencies.

2. **Effects:**
   i. The fire caused heavy loss of life and property. People were trapped inside, and some died due to smoke suffocation.
   ii. Many people suffered serious burns.
4. **Remedial Measures:**
   i. Fire engines, water tankers and ambulances were rushed to the site. The fire brigade and police rescued trapped people.
   ii. The injured were taken to the by ambulance.

II] Extra - Previous Years' Questions: (PYQs)

☆ 1 Mark Objectives ☆

1. MCQS:

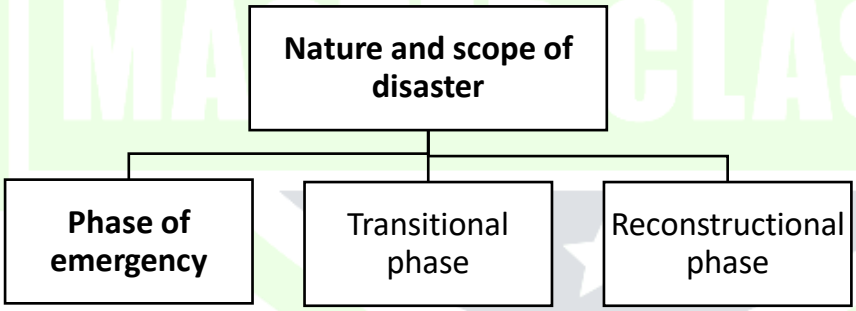
1. At the district level _____ is responsible for disaster management and implementation of rehabilitation schemes. [2025]

(A) Collector (B) Tahsildar (C) Education Officer (D) Chief Executive Officer

2. Volcano is a _____ disaster. [2022]

(A) Social (B) Political (C) Biological **(D) Geological**

2. Write the correct word in the box: [2026]



3. **True or False**: The chairman of national disaster management is Sarpanch. (**False**) [2026]

4. Write the full form of WHO. [2024]

Ans: full form of WHO is World Health Organization.

5. Write any one example of natural disasters. **Ans:** Floods [2022]

6. Find the odd one out: Earthquake, Flooding, Tsunami, **War** [2022]

☆ 2 Marks Questions ☆

1. Observe the following diagrams and complete table. [2024]

Disaster → Earthquake → Precaution → _____
Ans:

1. Do not panic. Take shelter under a table to protect yourself.
2. If you are outdoors, find a clear spot away from buildings, trees, electric poles and wires.

Snake Bite → Primary Stage → _____
Ans:

1. Keep the person calm and restrict any movement.
2. Tightly tie a handkerchief above the bite to prevent the poison from spreading and reaching the heart or the nervous system.



A

2. Write any four important facts which must be thought over while considering the scope of disaster. [2024]

Ans:

Taking into consideration the scope of disaster, some of the important facts must be thought over, as follows:
1) Pre-disaster phase 2) Warning phase 3) Emergency phase 4) Rehabilitation phase